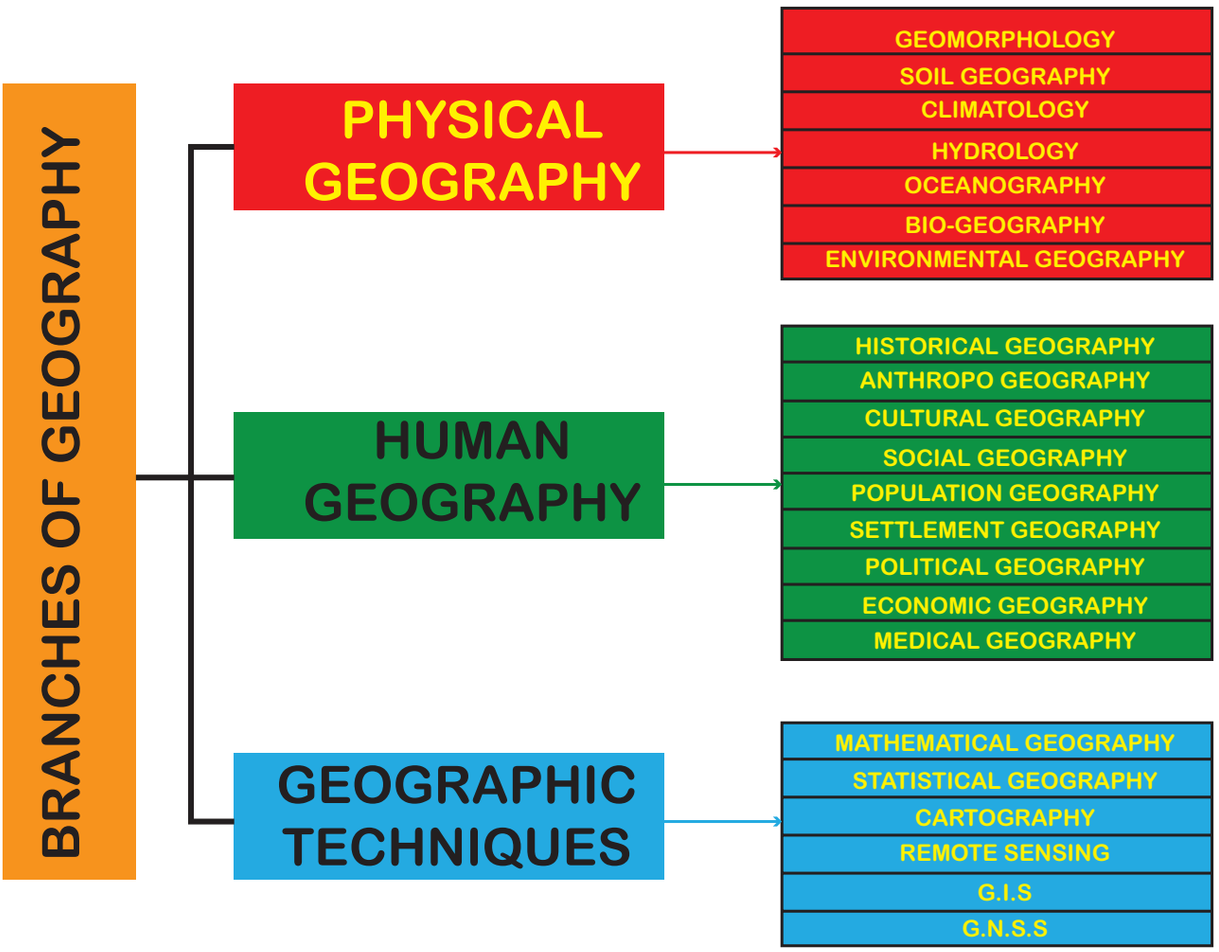


Figure 1.7 Branches of Geography

iv. ***Hydrology*** encompasses the study of earth's realm of water such as oceans and surface water bodies like rivers, reservoirs and ponds. It also makes a study of underground water and its recharge and also pollution of water bodies.

v. ***Oceanography*** is the study of seas and oceans. The shape, size, depth and bottom relief of ocean, distribution of oceans, ocean currents and various life forms existing in ocean are also studied under oceanography.

vi. ***Biogeography*** is a study of ecosystems over geographical space. It also analyses the changes in the ecosystems. *Phytogeography* or plant Geography, *Zoo Geography* or animal geography and *Ecology* are the branches of biogeography.

vii. ***Environmental Geography*** is the study of environmental issues arising out of misuse of various spheres of the earth and their implications. The ozone layer depletion, global warming, melting of polar ice caps, rising sea level and other related aspects are also given due importance. It also tries to give sustainable solutions to these problems.

1.7.2 Human Geography

Human Geography is concerned with the changes made by the humans over the natural or physical landscape. The ethnic and political aspects are taken into

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